LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Geography Word Lab: Earthquakes

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · when the ground shakes



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. We are huge pieces of the crust of Earth. We move very slowly.
2. I am a machine that records the shaking of the ground during an earthquake.
3. I am the point on the surface that is directly above the place where an earthquake starts.

2 COOL FACT: WHY DOES THE GROUND SHAKE?

An **earthquake** is a sudden shaking of the ground. The crust of Earth is broken into huge pieces called tectonic **plates**. The plates move very slowly, by a few centimetres every year. Sometimes they get stuck, and then they suddenly **slip**, and the ground shakes. The place under the ground where an earthquake starts is the **focus**. The point on the surface above it is the **epicentre**. Scientists use a **seismograph** to record earthquakes. In places with many earthquakes, builders make strong buildings.

sudden = very quick and not expected

stuck = not able to move

record = to save information

builders = people who make buildings

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

A	R	C	C	E	S	A	S	R	A	K	F
B	P	E	P	I	C	E	N	T	R	E	O
C	L	A	J	A	P	I	U	U	S	S	C
R	A	N	O	O	A	C	S	C	L	U	U
U	T	O	A	L	T	C	T	H	I	U	S
S	E	I	S	M	O	G	R	A	P	H	E
T	S	I	E	F	S	H	A	K	E	C	H
S	E	A	R	T	H	Q	U	A	K	E	R

WORD BANK

- ☐ **plates**
- ☐ **seismograph**
- ☐ **epicentre**
- ☐ **earthquake**
- ☐ **crust**
- ☐ **focus**
- ☐ **shake**
- ☐ **slip**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What is an earthquake?
2. What is the epicentre?
3. How do scientists record earthquakes?